BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
AIR FORCE SPECIAL OPERATIONS COMMAND

AIR FORCE SPECIAL OPERATIONS COMMAND MANUAL 11-2TSO, VOLUME 1

29 NOVEMBER 2023

Flying Operations

TACTICAL SYSTEMS OPERATOR AIRCREW TRAINING

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available for downloading or ordering on the e-Publishing web site at **www.e-publishing.af.mil**.

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication.

OPR: AFSOC/A3T

Certified by: AFSOC/A3T
(Col Michael L. Janssen)

Supersedes: AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV1, 16 August 2019

Pages: 30

This manual implements AFPD 11-2, *Aircrew Operations*, AFPD 11-4, *Aviation Service,* and AFMAN 11-202V1, *Aircrew Training*. It establishes standards for qualification, mission qualification, continuation, and upgrade training for Tactical Systems Operators (TSOs). This manual applies to AFSOC, including AFSOC gained Air National Guard and Air Force Reserve members. This manual does not apply to United States Space Force units. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* and are disposed IAW the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication in accordance with **paragraph 1.7.1**. The authorities to waive wing/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, T-3") number following a compliance statement. See DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to AFSOC/A3T for non-tiered compliance items in accordance with **paragraph 1.6**. This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all Supplements must be routed to the OPR of this publication for coordination prior to certification and approval in accordance with **paragraph 1.13.1**. This publication requires the collection and/or maintenance of information protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 authorized by Title 10 U.S.C., Sec 9013, *Secretary of the Air Force*; 37 U.S.C. 301a, *Incentive Pay: aviation career;* Public Law 92-204, *Appropriations Act for 1973*; Section 715 Public Law 93-570, *Appropriations Act for 1974; Incentive Pays and Continuation Bonus Program*; and Executive Order (E.O.) 9397 (SSN), as

amended by E.O. 13478, *Amendments to Executive Order 9397 Relating to Federal Agency Use of Social Security Numbers.* The applicable System of Records Notice (SORN) F011 AF XO A, Aviation Resource Management Systems (ARMS) is available at: **https://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNsIndex/DOD-Component-Notices/Air-Force-Article-List/**.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been substantially revised and needs to be completely reviewed. **Chapter 2** has been deleted and subsequent chapters have been renumbered. Major changes to the new **Chapter 2** include the modification of the universal qualification. A full difference training is required to become qualified to fly on the MC-12W or U-28A, MC-130J, AC-130J, and CV-22. Major changes to the new **Chapter 3** include adding FTL hours requirements from previous RTM and adding clarification to loss of currency scenarios. Major changes to the new **Chapter 4** include giving squadron commanders the ability to waive up to 20 percent of hours requirements for instructor upgrade candidates. Guidance for Remote Payload Operations hours applying to FTL added.

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Chapter 1

GENERAL GUIDANCE

1.1. General. This manual provides training management for Tactical Systems Operator (TSO) aircrew members. Training directive guidance, and requirements are set forth for each phase of aircrew training. Training is designed to progressively develop the combat readiness of each aircrew member, while maintaining previously acquired proficiency.

1.1.1. Initial Mission Qualification Training (**Chapter 2**) is made up of two parts and qualifies TSOs for tactical aircrew duties and to perform their command and unit's mission. Aircrew Cryptologic Certification Training (ACCT) and Mission Qualification Training (MQT) conducted at a formal training location make up IMQT.

1.1.2. Continuation Training (**Chapter 3**) provides the capability for aircrew members to reinforce and build upon previous training and conduct Air Force Task List, United States Special Operations Command (USSOCOM) Joint Mission Essential Task List, and MAJCOM Mission Essential Task List (METL) based, combat-oriented aircrew training.

1.1.3. Upgrade/Specialized Training (**Chapter 4**) identifies general prerequisites and training requirements for upgrades, including special mission qualification and certifications.

1.1.4. AFSOC flying units and FTUs may utilize digital training folders. Electronic training forms and folders are a suitable substitute for the AF Form 4109, *SOF/CSAR Aircrew Training Record*; 4110, *Comments - SOF/CSAR Training Record*; and 4111, *SOF/CSAR Training Record*.

1.2. Training Objectives. The overall objective of the aircrew training program is to develop and maintain a high state of mission readiness, facilitating immediate and effective employment in exercises, contingencies, limited war, and general war operations.

1.2.1. The training program is designed to ensure aircrew members have the knowledge, skills, and abilities (KSA) to accomplish assigned missions. The program leverages an extensive base of authoritative sources including Air Force official guidance, DoD regulations and guidance, federal air regulations, international standards and practices, and others.

1.3. Roles and Responsibilities.

1.3.1. **Air Combat Command Responsibilities (ACC).** ACC is responsible for the Aircrew Cryptologic Training (ACCT) portion of TSO training. ACC is responsible, through the 361ISRG/DOT, for the management of courseware, syllabus of instruction, certification, and training of TSOs for ACCT.

1.3.2. **National Guard Bureau (NGB) Responsibilities** . NGB is responsible for ensuring all aircrew meet appropriate formal school course prerequisites or possess an appropriate waiver prior to attending as well as all requirements outlined in the SILENT SHIELD RTM and roles and responsibilities outlined in 361 ISRG & 137 SOW inter-fly and support agreements.

1.3.3. **Air Force Special Operations Command (AFSOC) Responsibilities** . The AFSOC Commander is responsible for overall management of Air Force flying training programs for TSO employment with Air Force Special Operations Forces (AFSOF) and United States

Special Operations Command (USSOCOM). AFSOC is the lead command for TSO aircrew training. **(T-2)**

1.3.4. **AFSOC Operations (AFSOC/A3) Responsibilities.** AFSOC A3 is the focal point for all formal aircrew training management and is responsible for formal training matters such as curriculum, standardization of training programs, and flying hour management. AFSOC/A3 is also the waiver authority for specific aircrew training requirements. AFSOC/A3 may issue updated mission continuation training guidance via Ready Aircrew Program (RAP) Tasking Memorandum (RTM) as necessary to Operations Group (OG)/CC for implementation. **(T-2)**

1.3.4.1. The RTM prescribes a specific training period and requirements for continuation training once graduate level formal training is complete. RTM contents shall not be used as a basis for Syllabus of Instruction (SOI) minimum requirements.

1.3.5. **AFSOC/A3T Responsibilities** . AFSOC Training (AFSOC/A3T) is responsible for the oversight of the TSO formal school training programs. The 492 SOW in conjunction with AFSOC A3T is responsible for syllabus development, conducting initial/mission qualification, and instructor upgrades for TSO aircrew per this manual and Department of the Air Force Formal Schools Education & Training Course Announcements (ETCA).

1.3.5.1. Oversee TSO formal flying training and mission ready (MR) ground training events.

1.3.5.2. Monitor quality of training.

1.3.5.3. Coordinate prerequisite waiver requests for aircrew training courses.

1.3.5.4. Determine student training quotas required to maintain adequate crew force levels.

1.3.5.5. Allocate and monitor student quotas for aircrew training courses.

1.3.5.6. Ensure Standardization/Evaluation (Stan/Eval) trend analysis data is incorporated into formal aircrew training course reviews and Ready Aircrew Program (RAP) Tasking Memo (RTM) development.

1.3.5.7. Review and approve syllabi formal aircrew training courses. Conduct syllabus reviews every 2 years.

1.3.5.8. Review trend data on an annual basis for formal course review (FCR) and RTM development.

1.3.5.9. Review and recommend changes to ETCA for formal aircrew training courses.

1.3.5.10. Attend annual Program Flying Training (PFT) conferences, coordinate PFT issues, and monitor publication of PFT documents and subsequent revisions.

1.3.5.11. Validate Flying Hours Program (FHP).

1.3.5.12. Monitor resources required to meet aircrew training requirements and identify deficiencies in manpower, personnel, facilities, or training equipment.

1.3.5.13. Monitor graduate field evaluation programs per AFSOCI 36-2602, *Formal Aircrew Training Management.*

1.3.5.14. Review and approve syllabi and training plans for unit developed aircrew training courses.

1.3.5.15. Manage the contractor support for aircrew training devices and courseware.

1.3.5.16. Manage TSO simulator certification as applicable.

1.3.5.17. Produce a simulator event certification letter to delineate training that may be accomplished in specific Aircrew Training Devices (ATD).

1.3.5.18. Validate ATD suitability to credit simulator time for upgrade and experience levels.

1.3.5.19. Manage the acquisition and modification of aircrew training devices.

1.3.5.20. Program sufficient funding to maintain concurrency between aircraft and aircrew training system (courseware and devices).

1.3.6. **AFSOC/A2 Responsibilities.**

1.3.6.1. Manage the acquisition and modification of TSO training devices relating to JTWS or similar equipment.

1.3.6.2. Program sufficient funding to satisfy identified deficiencies in TSO aircrew training deficiencies related to special operations forces (SOF)-specific equipment/devices.

1.3.7. **Special Operations Wing/Group Responsibilities.**

1.3.7.1. Assign, by letter of appointment, a minimum of one TSO to work in the operations group (preferred), operations support squadron training office, or the operational unit to act as the operations group training Subject Matter Expert (SME). This individual will be instructor qualified. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.2. Develop programs to meet training objectives. Provide necessary staff support and assist subordinate units in management of training programs that meet unit needs. **(T-3)**

1.3.7.3. Attach each wing/group/Special Operations Support Squadron (SOSS) API-6 flyer to a flying squadron. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.4. Determine annual formal aircrew training quota requirements, submit quota requests to AFSOC/A3T, and manage quotas allocated. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.5. Ensure subordinate unit training offices are trained in regulations, procedures, and other facets of job performance. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.6. Ensure RTM guidance implementation to include Aviation resource management system (ARMS) training profile updates and squadron dissemination. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.7. Ensure squadrons establish annual training plans, conduct quarterly training review boards, and identify crew members for upgrade. **(T-2)**

1.3.7.8. Ensure squadron Stan/Eval trend data and instructor feedback are reviewed at a group-wide level on a semiannual basis. **(T-2)** Pertinent information from review will be disseminated to the individual squadrons for incorporation into squadron training plan.

1.3.8. **Operations Group (OG) commanders or Commander Air Force Special Operations Forces (COMAFSOF)** are the waiver authority for individual, case-by-case ground and flying training requirements as outlined below.

1.3.8.1. Extend ground training requirement due dates up to 2 months for AFSOC-specified Note 1 items in the RTM ground training table. Items required by other AFMANs will not be waived by the Special Operations Group (SOG) unless specifically authorized to do so in the source regulation. **(T-2)**

1.3.8.2. These events may count towards the next periodic requirements (units will note on waiver when events were accomplished, and the ARMS due date will be updated). **(T-2)**

1.3.8.3. See the current AFSOC SILENT SHIELD RTM for further guidance. **(T-2)**

1.3.8.4. May extend due dates for the duration of an exercise, contingency, or operational mission for events, IAW the AFSOC SILENT SHIELD RTM, on an individual basis only if the following conditions apply:

1.3.8.4.1. An aircrew member goes overdue while away from home station.

1.3.8.4.2. The training is not available at the deployed location.

1.3.8.4.3. Only applies to AFSOC-specified events. Items levied by other regulations may not be waived by the SOG unless specifically authorized to do so in the source regulation.

1.3.8.4.4. May waive flying training requirements (the TSO-specific tables of the AFSOC SILENT SHIELD RTM except as otherwise noted) on an individual basis only. Wings/groups must keep an accurate record of waivers granted. **(T-2)**

1.3.8.4.5. Will notify AFSOC/A3T of any SOG extensions.

1.3.9. **361 ISR Group Responsibilities** .

1.3.9.1. Prepare, review, and forward non-qualification/certification SOIs through the 492 SOTRG for final AFSOC/A3T approval.

1.3.9.2. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3T to ensure formal training graduates meet AFSOC requirements as defined by the ACC Mission Essential Task Listing (METL). This includes monitoring and adjusting syllabus content and quality as well as PFT quantity to produce crew members qualified to perform the AFSOC mission. The annual training review, syllabus review, and PFT conferences are the primary conduits for significant changes.

1.3.9.3. Recommend changes to ETCA through appropriate channels to AFSOC/A3T.

1.3.9.4. Determine TSO formal aircrew training quota requirements, submit quota requests to AFSOC/A3T, and manage quotas allocated.

1.3.9.5. Manage the acquisition, modification, and contractor support of all TSO aircrew training devices and courseware.

1.3.9.6. Identify and notify AFSOC/A3 and 16AF and then AFSOC/A2 of funding requirements to satisfy deficiencies of aircrew training and ensure realistic training on both aircraft and aircrew training devices.

1.3.9.7. Program force level forecasts for the next Presidential Budget submission plus the next Program Objective Memorandum cycle. HQ ACC, in coordination with HQ AFPC, will provide the projected number of assigned aircrew members for each time period, with corresponding authorizations and force turnover rates. **(T-2)**

1.3.9.8. Determine and validate manpower required to support aircrew training programs.

1.3.10. **Formal Training Unit (FTU) Responsibilities.**

1.3.10.1. **306 IS Responsibilities.**

1.3.10.1.1. Conduct and monitor TSO ACCT certifications.

1.3.10.1.2. Conduct and monitor TSO MQT and instructor upgrade training to meet all course objectives and standards.

1.3.10.1.3. Monitor and adjust syllabus of instruction (SOI) content and quality as well as PFT quantity to produce crew members qualified to perform the mission. The periodic Training Review, Formal Course Review (FCR), and Programmed Flying Training (PFT) conferences are the primary conduits for significant changes. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.4. Prepare, review, and forward all qualification SOI through the 492 SOTRG to AFSOC/A3T for coordination. Syllabi will contain a summary of revised, deleted, or added material and a resource impact statement (flying hours, manpower, facilities, etc.). **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.5. Recommend required changes to ETCA course catalogue through 361 ISRG/DOT. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.6. Conduct an FCR every 2 years in conjunction with AFSOC/A3T. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.7. Provide overall operation, logistics, and administration of TSO formal training courses. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.8. Administer end-of-course critiques and graduate field evaluations. Forward a summary of all critiques and evaluations to AFSOC/A3T for review. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3T to ensure formal school graduates meet unit requirements. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.9. Maintain a class roster of student entries and graduates for each formal course. Award AF Form 1256, Certificate of Training, to graduates per the ETCA. Maintain a record of certificates issued, to include graduate's name, rank, course completed, course number, dates of course entry and completion, and automated personnel data system (PDS) course code. Forward documents to individual’s base education office, as applicable. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.10. Notify AFSOC/A3T and gaining unit, in writing, when student graduation dates are extended 30 days past scheduled, or if students will graduate without completing all syllabus-training requirements. **(T-2)**

1.3.10.1.11. Forward current copies of courseware materials to units semiannually. **(T-2)**

1.3.11. **Intelligence Squadron/Detachment Commander Responsibilities.**

1.3.11.1. By letter of appointment, assign a minimum of one instructor TSO to the unit aircrew training office. The chief of the training section and/or the NCOIC should be a qualified instructor.

1.3.11.2. Ensure RTM guidance implementation to include ARMS training profile updates. Ensure crew members complete in-unit ground, qualification, and mission continuation training programs.

1.3.11.3. Ensure adequate training continuity and supervision of assigned crew members.

1.3.11.4. Assign additional requirements based on individual crew member experience and proficiency.

1.3.11.5. Review training records of newly assigned or attached crew members and those completing formal training to determine the necessary training required to complete/certify the individual as Mission Ready (MR)**.**

1.3.11.6. Assign Flying Training Levels (FTLs), and levels of qualification (e.g. instructor) or certification (e.g., evaluator) to assigned crew members (see the approved AFSOC RTM for description of training levels. Assign training levels based on experience and aircraft proficiency.

1.3.11.7. Establish annual squadron training plan. Any flying training that does not support TSO METLs, unit Mission Essential Task (METs), or formal school training should be questioned and reviewed.

1.3.11.8. Conduct quarterly training review boards to monitor training, correct deficiencies and identify crew members for upgrade.

1.3.11.9. Ensure Stan/Eval trend analysis data and instructor feedback are collected, analyzed, and incorporated into the squadron training plan.

1.3.11.10. Ensure supervisors complete the formal school post-graduate surveys IAW AFMAN 11-202V1.

1.3.11.11. Squadrons and Detachments will maintain mission ready status on unit assigned aircrew members. **(T-3)**

1.3.11.12. Squadrons will have six months from the time a new core mission event is added, and MAJCOM guidance issued to train to qualify aircrew in the new event. **(T-2)**

1.3.11.13. Commanders will not assign additional duties to first assignment “pipeline” TSOs for their first six months in the unit and not until after Combat Mission Ready (CMR) training is complete. **(T-2)**

1.3.11.14. Squadron commanders may carry new crew members as Mission Ready (MR) for up to six months if an aircrew member arrives at the unit after a PCS or formal school and is not MR in all core mission events.

1.3.11.15. If training is not complete in six months, the aircrew member becomes “non-mission ready” (NMR).

1.3.12. **Unit Training Office Responsibilities.**

1.3.12.1. Monitor unit training programs to ensure compliance with this instruction and applicable Air Force guidance on the training of aircrew members.

1.3.12.2. Maintain a training continuity book detailing proper training office management. Maintain a copy of the unit training officer appointment letter in the continuity book.

1.3.12.3. Maintain and update unit training office self-inspection checklist. Conduct self-inspection IAW group self-inspection program, but at least quarterly. A copy of the last two self-inspections and open discrepancy tracking sheets will be maintained using the Management Internal Control Toolset (MICT) IAW DAFI 90-302, *The Inspection System of the Department of the Air Force*. **(T-2)**

1.3.12.4. Submit waivers IAW **Para 1.6** and maintain a waiver tracking log. Notify unit operations officers and commanders on issues affecting readiness. Monitor status of unit training. Ensure flight commanders or designated representative monitor the quality of training being accomplished and identify training deficiencies to the training office. Report deviations and document significant trends affecting unit or individual training status to unit operations officers and commanders.

1.3.12.5. Initiate, track, review, and close out aircrew training folders and forms IAW AFMAN 11-202V1_AFSOCSUP, *Aircrew Training*.

1.3.12.6. Monitor and schedule training required by **Chapter 2** in conjunction with formal training courses.

1.3.12.7. If not already identified through ARMS products, track continuation training and notify individuals when either volume or frequency flying currency is lost. Notify unit operations officers and commanders on issues affecting readiness.

1.3.12.8. Schedule and conduct required or directed ground training to ensure all crew members receive training during applicable eligibility periods.

1.3.12.9. Maintain training material and equipment for recurring ground training events. Periodically review ground training material, tests, and computer-based instruction for currency.

1.3.12.10. Request off-station training through appropriate channels.

1.3.12.11. Conduct annual training reviews for all aircrew members. Coordinate with unit commander to ensure FTL appointment letter is updated.

1.3.12.12. Submit all secondary method training requests to AFSOC/A3T for approval via applicable Special Operations Groups (SOGs) in coordination with 361 ISRG/DO.

1.3.12.13. Ensure TSO students meet appropriate course prerequisites or possess an AFSOC/A3 approved waiver.

1.3.12.14. Coordinate with servicing Military Personnel Flight (MPF) to ensure the individual acknowledges any Active Duty Service Commitment (ADSC) or Reserve Duty Service Commitment (RDSC) required for in-unit initial qualification training and this ADSC/RDSC is properly processed once training is complete (see **Para 1.6**. Waivers).

1.3.12.15. Ensure instructors complete training folder entries before departing from post-mission debriefs whenever possible, but no later than 24 hours after land time. Ensure training documentation contains enough detail to ensure effective instructor and training continuity and clearly communicates students' strengths, weaknesses, and training accomplished during the event. **(T-2)**

1.3.12.16. Additional roles and responsibilities can be found in the AFMAN 11-202V1_AFSOCSUP.

1.4. Aircrew Training Guidance. The primary training method for TSO initial mission qualification, requalification, or upgrade training to instructor is attendance at an ETCA catalogued formal school. USAF policy dictates the use of formal schools unless attendance is impractical. The secondary method is in-unit training using applicable formal school courseware. Secondary method training (SMT) requires a waiver request be submitted through appropriate channels for approval by AFSOC/A3T (see **Para 1.6**.). Training accomplished in an operational unit designated by AFSOC/A3T to fulfill the role of an FTU is not considered SMT and does not require a waiver. Any aircrew member who was previously disenrolled from a formal ETCA course for substandard performance is ineligible for a secondary method training waiver. When specific formal courseware is not published, use of locally developed training syllabi is authorized. Units will forward all locally developed syllabi for in-unit training to AFSOC/A3T for review and approval in coordination with the 361 ISRG/DOT. All locally approved in-unit syllabi are posted on the AFSOC/A3T web page. **(T-2)**

1.4.1. AFSOC flying units and FTUs may utilize digital training folders. Electronic training forms and folders are a suitable substitute for the AF Form 4109, 4110, and 4111.

1.4.2. When specific formal courseware is not published, use of locally developed training syllabi is authorized. Units will forward all locally developed syllabi for in-unit training to AFSOC/A3T for review and approval in coordination with the 361 ISRG/DOT. All locally approved in-unit syllabi are posted on the AFSOC/A3T web page at **https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/AFSOC-AircrewTrng/SitePages/Home.aspx**. **(T-2)**

1.5. Service Commitments. Formal training, either primary or secondary method, conducted per this manual may incur a service commitment IAW AFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization and Classification*. Reference the appropriate regulation for program specifics. Individuals will acknowledge the incurred ADSC by signing the appropriate Service Commitment Acknowledgement Statement, prior to entering training. The unit training officer will notify AFPC/DPSFO via the servicing military personnel flight once training is complete. **(T-2)**

1.6. Waivers. Unless otherwise noted, the AFSOC/A3 is the waiver authority for the contents.

1.6.1. When unable to comply with guidance or procedures in this manual, unit personnel/training staff may request a waiver. All personnel should familiarize themselves with the waiver approval authorities as defined and described in DAFI 90-160, *Publications and Forms Management*.

1.6.2. AFSOC/A3 may grant group waivers for AFMAN 11-2MDSV1, *MDS Aircrew Training* and AFSOCMAN 11-2MDSV1, *MDS Aircrew Training,* and the associated RTM.

1.6.3. When a training item is directed by another instruction, refer to that instruction to determine the correct waiver authority (e.g., altitude chamber, combat survival training, etc.).

Table 1.1. Processing of Waiver Requests.

Waiver requested by:	Waiver Authority	Forward request through:	Reply sent to:	Info copy sent to:
Any unit (For items required by AFMAN 11-202v1)	HQ USAF/A3O	Special Operations Group/ (OGV for AFRC) to NAF/A3 (if applicable) to AFSOC/A3T to AFSOC/A3	Special Operations Group/ (Group/OGV for AFRC)	See below
Active Duty unit	HQ AFSOC/A3T	Special Operations Group/ DOT to HQ AFSOC/A3T	Special Operations Group/DOT	Requesting unit
AETC Formal School or AETC Unit	HQ AETC/A3F	Special Operations Group/ DOT to HQ 19 AF/A3FS to HQ AETC/A3F	Special Operations Group/DOT	AETC Formal School HQ AFSOC/A3T HQ 19 AF/A3FS
ANG unit	AFSOC/A3	Special Operations Group/DOT to AFSOC/A3T	Special Operations Group/DOT	NGB/A23610I, Requesting Unit
AFRC unit	HQ AFRC/A3T	Special Operations Group/OGV to 11 AF/DOT to HQ AFRC/A3T	Special Operations Group/OGV	11 AF/DOT, HQ AFSOC/A3T, Requesting Unit

1.6.4. Waivers to the requirements of this manual will be submitted through the group training office (SOG/OGT) to the SOG/CC, then to AFSOC/A3T for approval, unless otherwise specified. **(T-2)** SOG commanders are the delegated waiver authority for flying hour requirements and for ground and flying training requirements as outlined in this manual. The SOGs will keep an accurate record of all waivers granted and notify HQ AFSOC/A3T, as appropriate, by message when such waivers or extensions are issued. **(T-2)**

1.6.4.1. Units will maintain waiver logs for one year. As a minimum, track the following information **(T-2)**

1.6.4.1.1. Waiver type.

1.6.4.1.2. Approval authority.

1.6.4.1.3. Approval date.

1.6.4.1.4. Waiver number.

1.6.4.1.5. Waiver expiration date.

1.6.4.1.6. Copy of the signed waiver.

1.6.4.2. General Waiver Format. Crewmember's name, grade, flying organization (assigned or attached), present crew position (including special mission qualifications), total flying time and primary aircraft assigned (PAA) time (including instructor, evaluator and any ATD time, if applicable) and justification, crew qualification to which member is qualifying or upgrading, scheduled training start date, expected upgrade or qualification date, date last event accomplished, remarks, and requesting unit point of contact (include name, rank, telephone number, and office symbol). Waiver format templates are available on the AFSOC/A3T website. (**https://usaf.dfp.mil/teams/AFSOC-AircrewTrng/SitePages/Home.aspx**)

1.6.4.3. Units requesting waivers for SMT in-unit qualification, mission qualification, or upgrade of an aircrew member will send requests through appropriate channels to HQ AFSOC/A3T. Formal schools will forward current copies of courseware materials to units semi-annually. Maintain copies of all waivers in the individual's training folder. If the training incurs an ADSC, include the statement "Individual acknowledged receipt of ADSC by signing the AF Form 63, *Active Duty Service Commitment (ADSC) Acknowledgement Statement*, on <date AF Form 63 signed>. **(T-2)**

1.6.5. OG/CC or equivalent (e.g., COMAFSOF) may:

1.6.5.1. Extend ground training requirement due dates up to two months for Note 1 items in the AFSOC RTM, Ground Training Requirements Table on an individual basis only (Exception: Items levied by other regulations may not be waived by the OG/CC unless specifically authorized to do so in the source regulation). These events may count towards the next periodic requirements (units should note on waiver when events were accomplished, and the ARMS due date should be updated).

1.6.5.2. Extend due dates for the duration of an exercise, contingency or operational mission for AFSOC RTM Ground Training Requirements Table events on an individual basis only if a crew member goes overdue while away from home station and the training is not available at the deployed location (Exception: Items levied by other regulations may not be waived by the OG unless specifically authorized to do so in the source regulation).

1.6.5.3. Waive all flying training requirements IAW AFSOC RTM Tables (except as otherwise noted) on an individual basis only. Wings/groups will keep an accurate record of waivers granted. Notify HQ AFSOC/A3T when waivers are issued. **(T-2)**

1.6.6. Unit commanders may:

1.6.6.1. Carry new crew members as "mission ready" (MR) for up to six months if an aircrew member arrives at the unit after a PCS or formal school and is not MR in all core mission events. Units will notify AFSOC/A3T of any unit extensions. **(T-2)** Under no circumstance will aircrew perform events in which they are not qualified unless under the direct supervision of an instructor. If training is not complete in six months, the aircrew member becomes "non-mission ready" (NMR). Squadrons will have six months from the time a new core mission event is added and AFSOC guidance issued to train and qualify aircrew in the new event. **(T-2)**

1.6.6.2. Waive 20 percent of the Total and Primary Aircraft Authorized (PAA) hours required for upgrade in all crew positions, on an individual basis only once the crewmember has completed the Advanced Tactical Readiness (ATR) phase of Air

Commando Development. File a copy of the waiver in the individual's training record. Students attending formal school will bring a waiver letter to the formal school for insertion into their training record. **(T-2)**

1.7. Career Enlisted Aviator (CEA). CEA qualifications are not tied to AFMAN 36-2100 skill-level upgrade. All enlisted aircrew qualifications are separate and distinct from skill level qualification. When an AF Form 8, *Certificate of Aircrew Qualification* or an AF Form 8A, *Certificate of Universal Aircrew Qualification*, is completed for the applicable flight evaluation, then that crew member is qualified to perform all duties assigned to that crew qualification regardless of skill level. Aircrew instructor qualifications and flight examiner certifications are also separate and distinct from on-the-job training or certifier designation and are reflected in Air Force Specialty Code (AFSC) by use of "K" prefix (aircrew instructor), "T" prefix (FTU instructor), and "Q" prefix (aircrew flight examiner).

1.7.1. Changes. Recommendations for improvement to this manual are encouraged. Send recommendations to AFSOC/A3T through command channels on an DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*. AETC units will forward DAF Form 847s through Stan/Eval channels to AFSOC/A3V. AFSOC/A3 is the approval authority for changes or revisions to this instruction. These training requirements and currency adjustments may be made via RTM. AFSOC/A3 will be an info addressee on all changes.

1.7.2. Deviations. This instruction does not authorize deviations from the flight manual or any other Air Force Instruction or Manual. Flight safety should take precedence over the requirements and guidance of this instruction.

1.8. Command Relationship.

1.8.1. AFSOC and ACC. The AFSOC/ACC MOA outlines the inter-command relationships and responsibilities regarding AFSOC and the units of the 361 ISRG. The MOA outlines the administrative, cryptologic, logistical, resource, and operational responsibilities of AFSOC pertaining to the direct support relationship between AFSOC and the 361 ISRG.

1.8.2. AFSOC, ACC, and the United States Air Force Warfare Center (USAFWC). The AFSOC/ACC/USAFWC MOA outlines the inter-command relationships and responsibilities regarding operations at the 14 Weapons School.

1.9. Intra-command and Inter-command Transfer of Aircrews. For intra-command transfer of TSOs, the gaining organization will honor validated training completed by newly assigned crew members prior to the transfer. **(T-3)** For inter-command transfer, certifications and qualifications should be accepted to the maximum extent practical, only if training and evaluation standards are equivalent. The operations officer at the gaining unit should review the individual's career training folder and flight evaluation folder to determine which certifications and qualifications will be honored.

1.9.1. Permanent Change of Station (PCS) Screening. Losing units will screen individual flight and ground training records during unit out-processing. **(T-2)** Accomplish this screening in sufficient time to correct discrepancies prior to PCS. Losing units will provide a printed copy of current ground and flying training summaries to individuals prior to PCS. See DAFMAN 11-401, *Aviation Management,* for additional guidance. **(T-3)**

1.9.2. Instructor training and qualifications may be accepted at the discretion of the gaining unit commander.

1.9.3. Aircrew members qualified in the same MDS are considered qualified in that equipment throughout the force when used for the same mission. **(T-2)**

1.10. Interfly. TSOs assigned to the 361 ISRG are inherently approved for interfly on all aircraft supporting USSOCOM.

1.11. Initial Cadre.

1.11.1. Additional Aircraft. In the event TSOs are required to support an aircraft not listed in RTM, units will send a proposed initial cadre list including name, rank, flying time (by platform), total flying time, and current qualification level to AFSOC/A3 for approval. All initial cadre should be experienced instructors and/or evaluators.

1.11.1.1. The approved initial cadre will be responsible for sending a written assessment to AFSOC/A3T with recommendations for any additional training not covered by the Universal Qualification training. Upon consideration, AFSOC/A3T will update the RTM accordingly.

1.11.2. Additional Equipment or Capability. In the event TSOs are required to support additional equipment outside of their Universal Qualification, 361 ISRG will determine if the equipment or capability is different enough to warrant establishing an initial cadre. If so, units will send a proposed initial cadre list including name, rank, mission system experience, total flying time, and current qualification level to 361 ISRG/CC for approval. All initial cadre should be experienced instructors and/or evaluators.

1.11.2.1. The approved initial cadre will be responsible for working with 361 ISRG/DOT and AFSOC/A3T to develop training materials (including syllabi, courseware, or study guides, as appropriate), provide feedback for simulator/ATD development, develop tactics, and train other unit members in the new equipment or capability.

1.12. Mission Essential Task List. Squadrons will maintain mission ready status on all primary aircrew members up to unit authorizations. **(T-2)** Commanders will train aircrews to meet capabilities specified in unit METL found in the Air Force Universal Task List. **(T-3)**. Supervisory aircrew and staff members assigned above squadron level, which are in excess of the unit's mission requirements, will maintain mission ready, basic mission capable or basic aircraft qualification status, as required. **(T-3)**

1.12.1. Primary crew members will maintain Combat Mission Ready (CMR) status up to unit crew authorizations. Commanders will ensure aircrews are trained to meet unit capability requirements. Crew members assigned above unit manning levels, or surplus to unit authorizations, will maintain CMR or BMC status, as directed by the unit commander.

1.12.2. Commanders will not assign additional duties to first assignment "pipeline" (directly out of formal MDS training) crew members for their first six months in the unit. This guidance allows pipeline students to learn said weapon system(s) without the distraction of additional duties; all other personnel may be assigned additional duties. **(T-2)**

1.12.3. Aircrew members will not perform additional duties which detract from the primary duties of training for or performing the unit's flying mission.

1.13. Publication Administration. This manual is distributed to AFSOC, AFSOC-gained units, AFSOC-related schools, and other units as applicable based on requirements established through the Publishing Distribution Office. All aircrew members are authorized this manual.

1.13.1. Supplements. Forward all unit supplements to this manual to AFSOC/A3TA for approval. Provide AFSOC/A3TA, and applicable AFSOC/A3T a copy of all approved supplements. If required by mission or location, units may supplement this manual by coordinating with AFSOC/A3T before publication. **(T-2)**

1.14. Universal Qualification. TSOs are CEAs and are eligible for Universal Qualifications IAW AFMAN 11-202V2_AFSOCSUP, *Aircrew Standardization and Evaluation Program*. Universal Qualification will enable TSOs to fly on all light and medium fixed wing ISR aircraft listed in the RTM, without the need for individual certifications. TSOs will require individual difference training certifications for: AC-130J, MC-130J, and CV-22. The Light ISR, Strike, Mobility, and Tilt-Rotor aircraft, as outlined in AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2, *Tactical Systems Operator Evaluation Criteria*, para 1.1.1, each require difference training before the TSO can fly unsupervised. See **para 2.6** below for more information on difference training requirements. To ensure that TSOs are authorized to log primary time and credit missions while flying on AFSOC/SOCOM aircraft, the following guidance will be followed.

1.14.1. Upon determination of the TSO requirement to support SOCOM program and non-program of record aircraft, Air National Guard and Air Force Reserve Command mission aircraft and IAW AFMAN 11-421, *Aviation Resource Management,* para 4.4, local commanders or designated representatives will certify aircraft assignment based on the criteria in **para 1.14.2**, using AF Form 4324, *Aircraft Assignment/Aircrew Qualification Worksheet,* as MQ or IQ, as applicable.

1.14.2. Prior to first flight, local commanders or designated representatives certifying aircraft assignment will verify the individual has a valid and current AF Form 8/8a, Go/No-Go currency, active Aeronautical Orders, flight physical, and altitude chamber (if applicable) and has successfully completed aircraft familiarization or differences training on the AF Form 4348, *USAF Aircrew Certifications,* and AF Form 1522, *ARMS Additional Training Accomplishment Report*.

1.14.2.1. Aircraft familiarization and emergency egress must be accomplished before the TSO's first flight. For unit mission aircraft a qualified aircrew instructor must sign off the AF Form 1522. For aircraft not assigned to the TSO's home station, the following individuals are authorized to sign off the AF Form 1522: mission qualified or higher pilot, co-pilot or sensor operator, or TSO with hours on the aircraft and that is current on emergency egress in that aircraft.

1.14.2.2. Aircraft Differences training will be accomplished in accordance with **Chapter 3** below.

1.14.3. TSOs are authorized to log aircrew certification code (first character of crew position) "M", "I" or "E", as applicable, primary time, and currency/mission events as defined in the AFSOC RTM when criteria for each event is accomplished.

1.14.4. TSOs performing in-flight duties on non-USAF aircraft (i.e., GO/CO aircraft) will be responsible for filling out their own AFTO Form 781, *ARMS Aircrew/Mission Flight Data Document,* which will be validated by a commissioned officer.

1.14.5. TSOs performing in-flight duties on remotely piloted aircraft (i.e., MQ-9) will be responsible for obtaining and filling out their own AF Form 3521, *ARMS RPA Aircrew/Mission Flight Data Document,* which will be validated by a commissioned officer.

1.14.6. Refer to the current AFSOC RTM for aircraft included in the TSO UNIV QUAL. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3T for inclusion of additional aircraft to the TSO universal qualification.

Chapter 2

MISSION QUALIFICATION TRAINING

2.1. Overview. This chapter establishes the minimum training requirements for completing mission qualification. Aircrew members completing mission qualification will meet the requirements of this chapter. Upon completion of mission qualification training, the crew member will be assigned Mission Ready (MR) status. Mission qualification training is completed via the TSO Mission Qualification Training (MQT) syllabus posted on the AFSOC/A3TA website. Duties not directly related to qualification should be minimized.

2.1.1. This training provides the fundamental skills to the TSO Universal Qualification program. Newly-qualified TSOs will be able to perform in-flight aircrew duties in accordance with guidance provided in the AFSOC RTM.

2.2. General Requirements. The primary method of mission qualification is to complete the appropriate formal training course listed in the ETCA. Completing the appropriate formal course satisfies the training requirements of this chapter. When attendance is not practical or quotas are not available, units may request waivers to conduct secondary method training (SMT) IAW AFMAN 11-202V1_AFSOCSUP, using formal school courseware. Any aircrew member who has previously failed to successfully complete the ETCA formal course for substandard performance will not be issued an SMT waiver. Units may supplement courseware to meet local requirements. Submit all courseware change requests to AFSOC/A3T prior to implementation. Individuals transitioning from other aircraft or requalifying per requirements of **para 3.5.3** will complete the full TSO MQT course (proficiency advancement is encouraged). **(T-3)** Individuals unable to complete training within the time limits outlined below may continue training; however, units will immediately notify AFSOC/A3T through channels, in writing, with a description of the difficulty and expected qualification date. Commanders will ensure aircrew personnel complete training in a timely manner. Duties not directly related to this training should be minimized. **(T-2)**

2.2.1. Time Period Limits for in-unit MQT. Units will ensure that newly assigned personnel start qualification training within 45 days after reporting for duty. Commanders will ensure aircrew personnel engaged in qualification training complete their training in a timely and uninterrupted manner. **(T-2)**

2.2.2. Time Period Limits for In-Unit Instructor Qualification Training. TSOs enrolled into instructor training have 120 days to complete the training from the first ground training event or first flight, whichever comes first.

2.3. Training Prerequisites. Course prerequisites are IAW the appropriate formal course syllabus**,** the ETCA, AFMAN 11-202V1, and applicable supplements, and this manual. **(T-2)**

2.4. Ground Training Requirements. Complete all ground training IAW the AFSOC RTM, as part of MQT or prior to certifying individuals as mission ready. Mission sequence and prerequisites will be IAW the appropriate formal course syllabus, AFMAN 11- 202V1, and the RTM. Syllabus deviation waivers may be approved on a case-by-case basis by the unit operations officer or designated representative. MR crew members transferred from other units require only unit-specific mission ready training events or events which are due/overdue. Completion of training will establish due dates for recurring ground training required in **Chapter 4** and the current RTM. See **Chapter 4** and the current RTM for event descriptions. **(T-2)**

2.4.1. Academic Training. Complete all academic and ground training delineated in applicable courseware.

2.4.2. Written Examinations. Open and closed book qualification examinations will be completed before the completion of mission qualification flight training. Written examinations will satisfy the requirements of AFMAN 11-202V2, *Aircrew Standardization and Evaluation Program*, and AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2. When qualification training is completed by secondary method, the student will complete the appropriate group stan/eval or equivalent examination IAW AFMAN 11-202V2. **(T-2)**

2.5. Flying Training Requirements. Mission sequence and prerequisites will be IAW the appropriate formal course syllabus. Syllabus deviation waivers may be approved on a case-by-case basis by the unit or detachments operations officer. **(T-2)** Satisfactorily completing the appropriate ETCA formal course satisfies the requirements of this section. Approved in-unit qualification training must be accomplished IAW applicable formal school courseware and the guidance below:

2.5.1. Flying training lessons should be completed sequentially. If mission scheduling or student progress dictates otherwise, in-unit training sequences may be changed by the unit operations officer.

2.5.2. There should be minimum time lapse between training missions, and every effort should be made to complete mission qualification training requirements within the prescribed time period.

2.5.3. Crew member requirements may be completed on training or operational missions under the supervision of an instructor in the same aircrew position.

2.6. Difference Training Requirements.

2.6.1. TSOs may accomplish differences training to obtain additional certification on any AFSOC aircraft using AF Form 4348. Differences training is required before flying on any of the Strike, Mobility, and Tilt-Rotor aircraft as defined in AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2, para 1.1.1.

2.6.2. If not originally qualified on the U-28A or MC-12W, difference training will also be required if tasked to fly on either MDS. Completing difference training or mission qualification training on one of these two MDSs satisfies requirements for the other.

2.6.3. Differences training is an instructor certified event. There is no formal TSO difference training course. Difference training will be accomplished in unit or detachments and do not require an SMT waiver. TSO difference and conversion training is IAW HQ AFSOC/A3T approved syllabus of instruction. **(T-2)**

2.6.4. Instructors will adhere strictly to the syllabus for ground and in-flight training. Upon satisfactory completion of the applicable written closed book examinations and flight training requirements, the instructor will notify the unit training office, unit Stan/Eval, and SARM of the member's completion of difference training. **(T-2)**

2.6.5. Written Examinations. Closed book examinations will be completed before the start of difference flight training. The examination for purposes of difference training will include only the appropriate MDS addendums. For example, if adding AC-130J, the TSO will test on all C-130 related MQF addendums. **(T-2)**

2.6.6. TSOs will complete all required ground training prior to being declared mission ready. **(T-2)**

2.6.7. Once certified on the additional aircraft, TSOs will meet periodic evaluation requirements IAW AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2, Chapter 2.

Chapter 3

CONTINUATION TRAINING

3.1. General Requirements.

3.1.1. Requirements in this chapter satisfy the minimum flying and related ground training to maintain currency. Individual proficiency may require a greater number of events. The RTM contains all ground training and flying requirements tables and definitions.

3.1.2. Training requirements may be completed on any sortie if the accrediting criteria are met. Sorties and events that are compatible may be credited on the same flight.

3.1.3. Aircrew members will not log continuation training requirements in events in which they are unqualified.

3.1.4. Training events accomplished on an evaluation, or an instructor certification (that event) may be credited toward the individual's volume requirements.

3.1.5. Flying training events accomplished during formal training will use the course completion date (successful evaluation or certification date) to establish the due dates for all subsequent currency and requirements. Use actual dates for ground training.

3.1.6. Aircraft flying training requirements may be accomplished in an ATD as noted in the AFSOC RTM Flying Requirements Table.

3.2. Aircrew Status. A TSO may be assigned Mission Ready or Basic Mission Capable status.

3.2.1. Mission Ready (MR) Requirements. The following are minimum requirements for MR status:

3.2.1.1. Qualification and Mission Evaluation IAW AFMAN 11-202V2 and AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2.

3.2.1.2. Mission currencies (as applicable) IAW AFSOC RTM Flying Requirements by FTL Table.

3.2.1.3. Ground training (as applicable) IAW AFSOC RTM Ground Training Requirements Table.

3.2.1.4. Completion of Air Commando Indoctrination (ACI) and Combat Mission Ready (CMR) IAW AFSOCI 36-2601, *Air Commando Development.* **(T-3)**

3.2.1.5. Performance satisfactory to the unit commander. Awarding of MR status is solely at the discretion of the unit commander. Additional requirements may be added at their discretion.

3.2.1.6. Cryptologic Skills Program (CSP). TSOs are required to maintain CSPT currency IAW 361 ISRG guidance memorandum.

3.2.2. Failure to accomplish MR events results in non-mission ready status and the individual will not deploy as a crewmember.

3.3. Flight Training Levels (FTL). The use of experience-based FTLs allows the squadron commander to prioritize training resources. Aircrew members should meet the minimum criteria established in **para 3.2.1**, and **Table 3.1** below, before assignment to the respective training level.

When these minimums are met, awarding a training level is at the sole discretion of the squadron commander. **Note:** The aircrew member's availability to fly should not be a factor in assigning an FTL.

3.3.1. FTLs are based on TSO flight time (total MDS time for TSOs) and total flight time per Table 3.1. For mission qualification FTL, TSO flight time should include all types of MDS/WST time gained while operating a Silent Shield mission set.

3.3.1.1. For upgrade or FTL advancement purposes, flight hours gained from any form of Remote Payload Operations will only apply towards the below Total Hours requirements.

3.3.1.2. FTL "A"-Highly experienced MR aircrew members with 300 TSO-specific hours and 500 total flight hours onboard any operational aircraft.

3.3.1.3. FTL "B"-Experienced MR aircrew members with 100 TSO-specific hours and 300 total flight hours onboard any operational aircraft.

3.3.1.4. FTL "C"-Inexperienced MR aircrew members.

Table 3.1. Minimum FTL Hour Requirements.

FTL "A"	FTL "B"	FTL "C"
TSO Hours / Total Hours	TSO Hours/Total Hours	TSO Hours/Total Hours
300/500	100/300	Under 100/Under 300

3.3.2. Change of FTL. Squadron commanders may change an individual's FTL based on current RTM guidance. **(T-3)**

3.4. Proration of Training Requirements. See AFMAN 11-202V1 as supplemented.

3.5. Recurrency and Requalification Training. Training is required whenever an aircrew member does not meet a currency requirement in this manual and the AFSOC RTM. An aircrew member will not perform events unsupervised until training has been accomplished. **(T-2)**

3.5.1. Loss of Ground Training Currency.

3.5.1.1. Failure to accomplish events listed in RTM ground training tables results in a loss of currency for that event. Crewmembers are non-current the day after event currency expires.

3.5.2. Loss of Flying Requirement Currency.

3.5.2.1. TSOs must split CMPs evenly across all MDSs, but no less than 1 CMP per MDS will be logged per training period IAW the RTM. TSOs must meet the overall minimum volume of CMPs required per the assigned FTL to remain current as a TSO on all qualified all MDS.

3.5.2.2. Light ISR Exception: events logged on a U-28A or MC-12W satisfy currency and volume requirements for both MDS, but each event logged only counts once.

3.5.2.3. TSOs qualified on multiple MDSs that do not meet minimum flying currency requirements, IAW AFSOC RTM Flying Requirements by FTL Table**,** for an MDS in which they hold a qualification, are noncurrent only on the MDSs in which the requirements were not met. The individual is current and qualified on all platforms where

requirements are met. Individuals will complete at least one flight with an instructor to regain currency in that MDS. **(T-3)**

3.5.2.3.1. For example, a TSO who is FTL B and is U-28 and MC-130J qualified logged enough CMPs overall for FTL B only on the U-28. Since they logged enough CMPs for FTL B's overall volume requirements, the TSO is non-current only on the MC-130J because 0 CMPs were logged on the MC-130J.

3.5.2.4. TSOs qualified on a single MDS that do not meet minimum flying currency requirements for their assigned FTL over the course of a training period IAW the RTM are non-current.

3.5.3. Loss of Qualification.

3.5.3.1. TSOs qualified on multiple MDSs that do not meet AFSOC RTM Flying Requirements by FTL Table requirements for a second consecutive training period are unqualified only on those MDSs which the requirements were not met.

3.5.3.1.1. For example, a TSO qualified on MC-12W, U-28A, and MC-130J logged CMPs only on U-28As during the previous two training periods. IAW the RTM, this TSO will be unqualified on the MC-130J, but not the MC-12W due to the Light ISR exception above.

3.5.3.2. Regardless of the quantity of qualified MDSs, TSOs that do not meet their overall FTL CMP volume for a second consecutive training period IAW the RTM will become unqualified.

3.5.3.3. Discretionary disqualifications are documented using an AF Form 4348.

3.5.4. Regaining Currency.

3.5.4.1. Only Aircrew Proficiency Sortie events require a requalification evaluation if loss of currency exceeds 6 months (see AFMAN 11-202V1). Other events require showing proficiency to an instructor in the aircraft or simulator to regain currency.

3.5.4.2. If loss of Aircrew Proficiency Sortie currency exceeds 24 months, additional training will consist of ground and flight training at unit or detachment commander direction (ensure a training folder is opened).

3.5.4.3. Aircrew non-current in special mission events which only require an instructor certification (see RTM Ground Training Requirements Table) may regain currency by showing proficiency in that event to an instructor.

3.5.5. Requalification Training. Crewmembers requiring requalification will accomplish training IAW AFMAN 11-202V1, applicable MAJCOM supplements, and **Chapter 3** of this manual.

3.5.6. Requalification training plans for aircrew unqualified for more than 6 months, but less than 39 months, will be tailored to the individual’s skill and proficiency levels. The squadron commander will determine the minimum training events required. **Note:** TSOs who become unqualified may be requalified directly to instructor status, provided their training and evaluations include a review of instructor duties, procedures, and techniques.

3.6. Ground Training. Ground training will be accomplished IAW the AFSOC RTM Ground Training Requirements tables. Crew members will comply with the time periods listed for their FTL. Conduct training IAW the referenced publications, notes in RTM ground training table and the guidance below. The governing directive or RTM takes precedence over **Chapter 4** requirements. If the AFMAN 11-2MDSV1, *MDS Aircrew Training*, is also listed as a governing directive, the most restrictive guidance should be followed.

3.6.1. Failure to Complete Ground Training Events. Make-up training should be accomplished at the earliest opportunity. The following apply when crew members exceed due dates for the RTM ground training table.

3.6.1.1. Grounding items. Crew members will not perform flight duties until the grounding item is satisfied. **(T-2)**

3.6.1.2. Training status items. Crew members will not fly without instructor supervision. **(T-2)**

3.6.1.3. Mission items. Failure to accomplish mission events in the RTM ground training table results in non-mission ready status and the individual will not deploy as a crew member. **(T-3)**

3.6.2. Ancillary training. This volume is not a comprehensive list of all ancillary training required by the DoD. Ancillary training parent instructions take precedence over this manual for those training items.

3.6.3. Ground Training Events. See the current RTM for Ground Training Event definitions and requirements.

3.7. Flying Training. All aircrew members who maintain MR will accomplish all applicable training requirements IAW the RTM based on assigned FTL (A, B, or C). MR aircrew will also comply with the following: **(T-2)**

3.7.1. MR aircrew members will also accomplish applicable mission ready requirements from RTM Ground Training Requirements Tables as designated in the RTM according to their mission qualification and FTL. **(T-2)**

3.7.2. Instructors and flight examiners should not log events performed by other crew positions during instruction or evaluations.

3.7.3. Flying Training Events. See AFSOC RTM for Flying Training Event definitions and requirements.

Chapter 4

UPGRADE/SPECIALIZED TRAINING

4.1. General. This chapter outlines the prerequisites and training requirements for qualified aircrew members upgrading to additional levels of qualification.

4.2. Instructor Qualification. A sound and practical aircrew instructor program is a prerequisite for effective training, standardization, and aircraft mishap prevention.

4.2.1. Instructor Upgrade Prerequisites. Unit or detachment commanders will personally review each candidate's qualifications and select instructors based on their background, experience, maturity, and ability to instruct. The following characteristics must be considered: **(T-3)**

4.2.1.1. Instructional Ability. An instructor is a teacher and must understand the principles of instruction. Instructors should exemplify a higher level of performance and present themselves a reliable and authoritative expert in their respective duty positions.

4.2.1.2. Judgment. The candidate should possess judgment necessary to meet unexpected or induced emergencies and the ability to exercise sound judgment through mature realization of their own limitations, as well as those of the student and the aircraft.

4.2.1.3. Personal Qualities. The candidate should have patience, tact, understanding, and a desire to instruct others. Instructors should have a personality that inspires and wins the respect of each student.

4.2.1.4. Technical Knowledge. The candidate should be generally familiar with ISR aircraft, aviation principles, and typical normal/emergency operating procedures. The candidate should also be thoroughly familiar with the TSO mission, procedures, and equipment. Additionally, all instructors must be thoroughly familiar with aviation management, flying training, and flying operations publications.

4.2.1.5. Flying Experience. Candidates should possess a reasonable background of flying experience to have developed a desired standard of knowledge, judgment, and proficiency. Normally, these qualities progress together. However, flying hours alone cannot be accepted as criteria for any one or all of the qualities required.

4.2.1.6. Initial Instructor Candidates. All initial instructor upgrade candidates should be mission ready in their unit or detachment's mission for a minimum of six months, Advanced Tactical Readiness (ATR) complete IAW AFSOCI 36-2601, and meet the flying hour requirements identified in **Table 4.1** below. Reference current RTM for any other restrictions.

4.2.1.7. Reference **para 1.6.6.2** above for Unit Commander waiver authority.

Table 4.1. Minimum Hours Required for Upgrade to Instructor.

CREW POSITION	TSO HOURS	TOAL HOURS
Instructor TSO	100	300

4.2.2. Instructor Deficiencies. Instructors who demonstrate deficiencies in their ability to instruct may be used in their primary crew position, provided the deficiency does not involve primary crew duties. Commanders will take the necessary action to either retrain or remove those individuals from instructor status per Air Force and AFSOC directives. **(T-2)**

4.2.3. Ground and Flight Training Requirements. Before being designated an instructor, candidates will demonstrate to a flight examiner their ability to instruct and their knowledge of applicable directives. In addition, all candidates will adhere to the following: **(T-2)**

4.2.3.1. Qualify in the applicable formal school instructor course. If no formal school instructor course exists, conduct in-unit ground and flying training IAW the AFSOC approved TSO Instructor Upgrade SOI. **(T-2)**

4.2.4. Instructors exhibiting substandard performance should be reviewed for suitability of continued instructor duty. Instructors will be decertified if:

4.2.4.1. Awarded a less than fully qualified grade in any area of a flight evaluation regardless of overall crew position qualification.

4.2.4.2. A qualification or emergency procedures evaluation (EPE) is failed.

4.2.4.3. Unit or detachment commander deems instructor is substandard, ineffective, or providing incorrect procedures, technique, or policy guidance.

4.2.4.4. Decertified instructors may regain instructor status by correcting applicable deficiency and completing training and/or evaluation as specified by SQ/CC or SQ/DO.

4.2.5. Instructor Requalification. Instructor candidates who were previously qualified as instructor TSOs may requalify directly to instructor status.

4.2.6. Instructor Transfers. Instructor candidates who were previously qualified as instructor TSOs may be trained in-unit at the discretion of the unit commander.

4.3. Flight Examiner Upgrade. Flight examiners are selected from the most qualified and competent instructors. Before being certified as a flight examiner, candidates will demonstrate satisfactory knowledge of command training and evaluation policies, procedures, and appropriate forms completion. Additionally, they will demonstrate the ability to administer an evaluation IAW AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2. Conduct initial training IAW AFSOC approved AF Form 4111 or electronic forms. Certification will be annotated on AF Form 4348. **(T-3)**

MICHAEL E. CONLEY, Brig Gen, USAF
Director of Operations

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 Mar 2020

AFMAN 11-202V1, *Aircrew Training*, 27 Sep 2019

AFMAN 11-202V1_AFSOCSUP, *Aircrew Training*, 18 Jul 2022

AFMAN 11-202V2, *Aircrew Standardization and Evaluation Program*, 30 Aug 2021

AFMAN 11-202V2_AFSOCSUP, *Aircrew Standardization and Evaluation Program*, 5 Aug 2022

AFMAN 11-421, *Aviation Resource Management*, 23 Mar 2020

AFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization and Classification*, 7 Apr 2021

AFPD 11-2, *Aircrew Operations*, 31 Jan 2019

AFPD 11-4, *Aviation Service*, 12 Apr 2019

AFSOCI 36-2601, *Air Commando Development*, 20 Aug 2020

AFSOCI 36-2602, *Formal Aircrew Training Management*, 8 Jul 2020

AFSOCMAN 11-2TSOV2, *Tactical Systems Operator Evaluation Criteria*, 29 Nov 2023

DAFI 90-160, *Publications and Forms Management*, 14 Apr 2022

DAFI 90-302, *The Inspection System of the Department of the Air Force*, 15 Mar 2023

DAFMAN 11-401, *Aviation Management*, 27 Dec 2020

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 18 Oct 2023

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

AF Form 8, *Certificate of Aircrew Qualification*

AF Form 8A, *Certificate of Universal Aircrew Qualification*

AF Form 63, *Active Duty Service Commitment Acknowledgement Statement*

AF Form 1256, *Certificate of Training*

AF Form 1522, *ARMS Additional Training Accomplishment Report*

AF Form 3521, *ARMS RPA Aircrew/Mission Flight Data Document*

AF Form 4109, *SOF/CSAR Aircrew Training Record*

AF Form 4110, *Comments - SOF/CSAR Training Record*

AF Form 4111, *SOF/CSAR Training Record*

AF Form 4324, *Aircraft Assignment/Aircrew Qualification Worksheet*

AF Form 4348, *USAF Aircrew Certifications*

AFTO Form 781, *ARMS Aircrew/Mission Flight Data Document*

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACCT—Aircrew Cryptologic Certification Training

ADSC—Active Duty Service Commitment

AFPC—Air Force Personnel Center

AFRC—Air Force Reserve Command

AFSC—Air Force Specialty Code

AFSOF—Air Force Special Operations Forces

ARMS—Aviation Resource Management System

ATD—Aircrew Training Device

ATR—Advanced Tactical Readiness

BAQ—Basic Aircraft Qualification

BMC—Basic Mission Capable

CEA—Career Enlisted Aviator

CSAR—Combat Search and Rescue

CSPT—Cryptologic Skills Proficiency Test

CT—Continuation Training

CTF—Career Training Folder

ETCA—Education and Training Course Announcements

FCR—Formal Course Review

FTL—Flying Training Level

FTU—Formal Training Unit

GO/CO—Government Owned/Contractor Operated

KSA—Knowledge, Skills, and Ability

MDS—Mission Design Series

METL—Mission Essential Task Listing

MOA—Memorandum of Agreement

MQT—Mission Qualification Training

MR—Mission Ready

NAF—Numbered Air Force

NGB—National Guard Bureau

NMR—Non-Mission Ready

OG—Operations Group

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PAA—Primary Aircraft Authorization

PCS—Permanent Change of Station

PDS—Personnel Data System

PFT—Programmed Flying Training

RAP—Ready Aircrew Program

RDS—Records Disposition Schedule

RPL—Required Proficiency Level

RQT—Requalification Training

RPO—Remote Payload Operations

RTM—Ready Aircrew Program Tasking Memorandum

SMT—Secondary Method Training

SOI—Syllabus of Instruction

STAN/EVAL—Standardization and Evaluation

TSO—Tactical Systems Operator

USSOCOM—United States Special Operations Command

Terms

Aircrew Training Device (ATD)—A hardware device that permits learning, development, and the practice of skills and procedures necessary for understanding and operating the integrated systems of a specific prime mission system.

Basic Mission Capable—An aircrew member who has satisfactorily completed mission qualification and is maintaining 50 percent of the applicable mission qualification currency requirements. Basic mission capable crew members may perform primary crew duties on any unilateral training mission. For other missions, the unit commander will determine the readiness of each basic mission capable crew member to perform primary crew duties.

Currency—For the purposes, currency will refer to frequency volume as used by ARMS. This is used for events that are required with a specified number of days instead of a monthly, quarterly, or semi-annual period.

Eligibility Period—The 6-month period prior to the due date of an evaluation or required event.

Event—A training item to be accomplished. Multiple events may be completed and logged during a single sortie.

Mission Design Series (MDS)—The official designation for aerospace vehicles used to represent a specific category of aerospace vehicles for operations, support, and documentation purposes.

Mission Essential Task Listing (METL)—A complete list of mission essential tasks (MET) for any organization

Mission Profile—A mission designed to penetrate and operate within a combat or threat environment. The specific profile will be predicated on the type and level of threat.

Mission Ready—An aircrew member who has satisfactorily completed mission qualification and is maintaining all the applicable mission qualification currency requirements.

Primary Aircraft Authorization (PAA)—TSO hours gained while flying and operating a Silent Shield mission set.

Required Proficiency Level (RPL)—The level at which a student will perform at a particular phase of training. Use grading standards and definitions per AFSOCI 36-2602 and AF Form 4111.

Requalification Training (RQT)—Training required to qualify crew members in an aircraft or mission in which they have been previously qualified.

Secondary Method Training—Formal training conducted at a location not designated as an FTU using SOI and courseware.

Special Mission Qualification Training—Training given in a specific mission area/task that requires a flight evaluation in that mission area or task. This training is not required to be mission ready/combat mission ready or basic mission capable.

Total Flying Time—Total time for all aircraft flown in military service to include student time.

Training Status—A status in which all of a crew member's flying training is done under the supervision of an instructor in the crew member’s respective crew position.

Volume—For the purposes, volume refers to the number of events an aircrew member will accomplish in a given period of time (i.e.: quarterly or semi-annually).

Weapon System Trainer (WST)—Device that provides synthetic flight and tactics environment in which aircrews learn, develop, improve, and integrate skills associated with their crew position. In this manual, WST and simulator are synonymous.